

For gamers, the 3DMark Wildlife Extreme score skyrocketed to 3,240, a massive 26% increase over its predecessor. This finally puts the Pixel in the top tier of gaming phones, capable of running the most graphically demanding titles at high frame rates with sustained stability.



Of course, a Pixel's performance isn't just about raw numbers. It's about the software. The phone runs a pristine version of Android 16, with a major design refresh called "Material 3 Expressive." Building on the principles of Material You, this is Google's most researched design update ever, leveraging 46 studies with over 18,000 participants. This translates to a UI that feels alive.

Animations are fluid and natural, with satisfying springy effects when dismissing apps or notifications. Interactions are paired with crisp haptic feedback for a more tactile feel and a subtle background blur in the notification shade adds a sophisticated sense of depth. Beyond aesthetics, Android 16 brings powerful quality-of-life improvements. The new Live Updates feature intelligently presents glanceable, real-time information from services like ride-sharing or food delivery front and centre. The home screen grid and Quick Settings have also been updated with better alignment and more customisation options.

At the core of this experience is Google's advanced AI, now fully integrated as Gemini. Powered by the on-device Gemini Nano model, the entire suite of Pixel-exclusive features feels faster and more capable. Established tools like Circle to Search, Live Translate

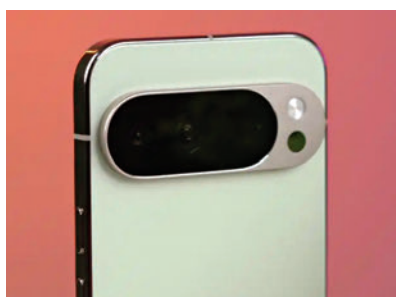
and Call Assist are joined by powerful new capabilities such as Gemini Live, Magic Cue and enhanced Pixel Screenshots. And with seven years of OS upgrades promised, this is a phone designed to age like fine wine.

BATTERY LIFE AND CHARGING

In our daily use, the phone proved to be a true all-day champion, comfortably lasting from morning to night with heavy use involving photography, social media, and a couple of hours of gaming, with around 15-20% left in the tank, giving us 6-7 hours of screen on time, which is solid.

In the PCMark battery life test, which simulates continuous mixed usage, the Pixel 10 Pro XL lasted an impressive 16 hours and 36 minutes, over two hours longer than the Pixel 9 Pro XL.

When it comes to charging, the phone supports 45W wired charging, and we clocked a full 0-100% charge in 87 minutes. Furthermore, Google has embraced modern standards with support for 25W wireless charging via the new universal Qi2 standard, and the inclusion of bypass charging is a welcome feature for gamers, allowing it to run on direct power to reduce heat and battery strain during intense sessions.



CAMERA PERFORMANCE

On paper, the camera hardware hasn't changed. We get a powerful trio of a 50MP wide, 48MP ultrawide and 48MP 5x telephoto, but the story, as always with Pixel, is about the software. After putting the phone through its paces in a variety of challenging scenarios, one thing is clear: the Pixel 10 Pro XL doesn't just take pictures; it captures

moments with an intelligence that often borders on magic.

The 50MP main camera is the system's anchor and it's nothing short of phenomenal. In bright daylight, the large 1/1.31" sensor and wide f/1.7 aperture work together to produce images with incredible detail and a pleasing, natural depth of field and true-to-life colours. But it's when the sun goes down that the Pixel's legend truly comes alive. Night Sight is better than ever, transforming dimly lit scenes into bright, clean and atmospheric photos. It expertly handles extreme dynamic range, retaining highlights in bright neon signs while pulling out detail from deep shadows, all without excessive noise. The 48MP ultrawide camera gives you an expansive 123° field of view is perfect for dramatic architectural shots and sweeping landscapes. Google's processing does an excellent job of correcting for distortion, keeping lines straight even at the edges of the frame. Where it truly shines, however, is with the automatic Macro Focus mode.

WHO SHOULD BUY THIS?

- If you're on a Pixel 8 Pro or older, it's a massive, across-the-board upgrade.
- If you're on the Pixel 9 Pro XL, the gains are subtler, but the improved display and performance are still tempting.
- If you simply want the most intelligent, reliable camera phone, with software that genuinely feels helpful (not gimmicky)? This is it.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Google Tensor G5 | RAM: 16 GB | Storage: 256 GB | Display: 6.8-inch LTPO OLED panel | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Cameras (Rear): 50MP Main + 48MP Ultrawide + 48MP 5x Telephoto | Cameras (Front): 42MP | Battery: 5200 mAh | Charging: 45W Wired | IP Rating: IP68

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